

PROSPER AWUNI

Internal Cyber Defence Consultant | Blue Team Leadership | Detection Engineering | Threat Hunting

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified cyber security professional with over five years of hands-on experience shaping and maturing defensive security operations, detection engineering, threat hunting, and incident response capability within complex enterprise environments. I have a strong track record of leading Blue Team functions, overseeing Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Security Orchestration, Automation, and Response (SOAR), Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), and Network Detection and Response (NDR) technologies across the Microsoft security suite. I am skilled in detection rule authoring, alert tuning, log analysis, and data correlation, with deep familiarity with the MITRE ATT&CK framework and cyber kill chain. I have demonstrated experience conducting and leading incident response and digital forensics investigations, executing structured threat hunting programmes, and overseeing vulnerability management, and I am ready to set the strategic direction for a Blue Team capability while ensuring the organisation remains resilient against an ever-evolving threat landscape.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM/SOAR:** Microsoft Sentinel (KQL), CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, detection rule authoring, alert tuning, log analysis, data correlation, SOAR playbook development
- **EDR/NDR:** CrowdStrike Falcon EDR/Prevent/Insight/Discover, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender
- **Threat Hunting:** MITRE ATT&CK framework, cyber kill chain, structured hunting methodologies, Indicators of Compromise (IOC) analysis, hypothesis-driven investigation
- **Incident Response and Digital Forensics:** NIST 800-61 full lifecycle (detection, analysis, containment, eradication, recovery, lessons learned), IR playbook development, digital forensics investigations, root cause analysis
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS)
- **Identity and Access:** Azure Active Directory (Azure AD)/Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Role-Based Access Control (RBAC), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Frameworks:** NIST CSF, ISO 27001, CIS Controls, Cyber Essentials+, NCSC CAF
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, KQL
- **Other Security Tools:** Mimecast, Check Point Harmony firewall, Tanium, Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

March 2025 - Present

University of the Arts London (UAL), London

- Shape and mature the organisation's defensive security operations across an 8,000-user enterprise environment, setting direction for detection engineering, threat hunting, incident response, and vulnerability management capability.
- Design and maintain advanced detection logic in Microsoft Sentinel using Kusto Query Language (KQL), informed by Cyber Threat Intelligence (CTI), MITRE ATT&CK gap analysis, and lessons learned from incident investigations.
- Execute threat hunts across SIEM, EDR, and endpoint telemetry using structured methodologies aligned with MITRE ATT&CK and the cyber kill chain, converting findings into actionable detection rules and platform tuning recommendations.
- Lead incident response investigations through the full lifecycle from detection to root cause analysis, containment, eradication, and lessons-learned review, following NIST 800-61 methodology; author and maintain IR playbooks and procedures.

- Conduct digital forensics investigations in support of incident response, gathering and preserving evidence across endpoints, identity systems, and cloud environments.
- Oversee Managed Detection and Response (MDR) and Managed Security Service Provider (MSSP) provider performance, reviewing escalation quality, providing structured feedback, and guiding joint detection tuning sessions.
- Manage CrowdStrike Falcon (NG-SIEM, EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover) and Microsoft Defender (MDE, MDI, M365 Defender) across the enterprise, optimising platform configuration, detection policies, and telemetry coverage.
- Oversee the vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentera BAS, prioritising remediation by risk and reporting to senior stakeholders.
- Develop SOAR playbooks to automate alert triage workflows, significantly reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) and analyst workload.
- Administer BeyondTrust PAM and Azure AD/Microsoft Entra ID, enforcing least privilege and Zero Trust access principles across the enterprise.
- Leverage Tanium for real-time endpoint compliance monitoring and vulnerability management, using asset discovery, software inventory and patch compliance modules to maintain accurate endpoint visibility and enforce compliance baselines across the estate.

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

University of the Arts London (UAL), London

- Operated SIEM and EDR platforms daily, conducting alert triage, log analysis, and data correlation to detect, investigate, and escalate security events; contributed to detection rule development and alert tuning.
- Supported incident response investigations including evidence gathering, log analysis, containment, and remediation; assisted with digital forensics tasks under senior guidance.
- Contributed to structured threat hunting activities aligned with MITRE ATT&CK, identifying previously undetected threats and translating findings into detection improvements.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Nessus and AppCheck; tracked remediation progress and reported on risk posture.
- Administered Azure AD Conditional Access, MFA, and RBAC policies; supported identity and access management operations.
- Developed PowerShell automation scripts to streamline repetitive security operations tasks.
- Contributed to ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials+ compliance activities, gathering evidence and supporting control assessments.

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech), London

- Delivered security assessments and improvement initiatives across a Software as a Service (SaaS) and FinTech cloud infrastructure environment.
- Managed endpoint security tools, network security controls, and IT infrastructure across cloud and on-premises systems.
- Supported ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials compliance programmes, contributing to audit preparation and evidence collection.
- Provided security and IT infrastructure engineering support, improving platform resilience and security posture.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Elevated Blue Team maturity at UAL by introducing a structured, MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection engineering programme, a recurring threat hunting schedule, and SOAR-driven automation, materially reducing mean time to detect (MTTD) and MTTR.
- Led deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) across 8,000 users, establishing full EDR telemetry coverage and substantially improving endpoint visibility and response capability across the enterprise.

- Developed a comprehensive library of incident response playbooks aligned with NIST 800-61, standardising the organisation's response to high-frequency threat scenarios and reducing remediation time.
- Established a structured MDR/MSSP oversight process including escalation quality reviews and joint tuning sessions, improving detection fidelity and reducing false positive escalations.
- Achieved CISSP certification, demonstrating expert-level knowledge across all eight domains of information security, reinforcing the breadth and depth of expertise required for a senior Blue Team leadership role.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Salary Expectation: GBP75,000-90,000+ | Hybrid (London/UK)